Emergency Preparedness Quick Start

Do these first. Write down your choices, share them with your household, and practice them.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

If danger is immediate: follow official instructions and move to safety. Do not delay an evacuation to finish a plan or collect supplies.

TODAY: MAKE CONTACT POSSIBLE

- ☐ Choose one out-of-area contact everyone can reach.
- ☐ Save local emergency-alert and trusted information sources.
- ☐ Pick two meeting places: one near home and one outside your neighborhood.
- ☐ Write the plan on paper; place a copy in each go-bag.

Go deeper: Use **COM-003** to set up alerts, **COM-004** to save official sources, and **STH-005** to plan caregiver contacts, pickup, and reunification.

If you spot a suspected wildfire: use **COM-001 — Report a Wildfire Sighting**.

NEXT: PLAN HOW YOU WILL LEAVE

- ☐ Choose more than one route and decide where you could stay.
- ☐ Plan transportation now; include a backup if you do not drive.
- ☐ List the help, equipment, medication, communication, and power each person needs.
- ☐ Include every animal: carrier or restraint, transport, identification, supplies, and a destination that will accept it.

Go deeper: Use **STH-004 — Disability & Access Planning** for individual access and functional needs, and **STH-006 — Animal Planning** for pets, service animals, and other animals.

THEN: KNOW WHAT MAY HAPPEN

- ☐ Ask your local emergency-management authority which hazards affect your address and what actions it recommends.
- ☐ Use **STH-003 — Know Your Local Hazards** to record the official alerts and protective actions for your location.
- ☐ Practice one part of the plan, then update names, routes, and needs.

Emergency Preparedness Quick Start — continued

COMPLETE YOUR HOUSEHOLD PLAN

Use **EVS-001 — Evacuation Readiness Checklist** to track readiness, **EVS-002** for portable go-bags, **EVS-003** for departure decisions, **EVS-004** for routes, and **EVS-005** for transportation. Use **COM-005** to record contacts and meeting places.

Build supplies next: use **STH-002 — Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit**. Store what your household can safely carry and use.

Keep the plan usable: use **STH-007 — Annual Binder & Kit Review** every year and after a household change, move, drill, or emergency. Replace expired supplies and update contacts, routes, equipment, medications, and care needs when they change.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Make a Plan,” “Alerts & Warnings,” “Evacuation,” “Build A Kit,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” “Prepare Your Family,” “Pets and Animals,” and “Get Tech Ready.” Accessed 2026-09-25.